



WISCONSIN HIGH SCHOOL CLIMBING LEAGUE

OVERVIEW



Coaches,

Welcome to the Wisconsin High School Climbing League! I am so happy you have decided to coach a high school climbing team. Whether you have been coaching for 20 years or are brand new to the league, you are a valued part of this organization. This league would not be possible without you and your dedication to youth in climbing.

This binder is your guide to the WHSCCL and contains helpful information for you, including a League Directory, Season Calendar, Startup Packet, Handbook, and Rulebook. As a coach, it is your responsibility to uphold the values of the league and relay information in this booklet to your student athletes and their families. If you have any questions or need any support, I am always happy to help.

Thank you again for your commitment to fostering the love of climbing within high school students across the state of Wisconsin.

Rock On!

Lizzy



WHSCCL DIRECTOR

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MISSION

The WHSCL provides a fun and welcoming environment, encourages an active lifestyle, builds social bonds, and promotes a love for the sport of rock climbing to high school students across the state of Wisconsin through competitions and weekly practices.

VISION

To empower high school students to climb and to legitimize rock climbing as a competitive high school sport.





CORE VALUES

Fun and Welcoming

The WHSCL has been and always will be a welcoming environment for all Wisconsin high school students, regardless of any race, religion, political belief, social status, gender, sexuality, or ability. This environment is created by the collective of coaches in the league and through each and every student.

Active Lifestyle

Physical fitness is key to climbing and demands a certain level of dedication. Since each student climbs at a different difficulty, they are encouraged to find an individualized exercise plan that matches their goals. Ideally, this plan evolves into a healthy, active lifestyle.

Community

The fun and welcoming environment created by each team should organically lead to building social bonds. Our goal is to not only bring students together to be teammates but to also be friends. Climbing, although thought of as an individual sport, is a team activity. Students will need to rely on each other on and off the wall.

Love for Rock Climbing

Rock Climbing is not only a sport but also a lifelong activity. Students are encouraged to discover what they love about climbing to promote lifelong participation. While some students prefer top-rope climbing, others will prefer bouldering. No matter what discipline appeals to each student, our desire is to foster the enjoyment for the sport as a whole.



INTRODUCTION

The Wisconsin High School Climbing League (WHSC) was started by Andy Miers as part of a marketing internship with Adventure Rock, through UW-Milwaukee, in 2009. The league started with three teams, 30 students, and a mission to provide high school students an alternative option to conventional athletics while targeting a demographic Adventure Rock had yet to effectively capture. As the league expanded, this mission also expanded to include the whole state of Wisconsin.



A high school climbing team can impact students in many ways. While offering an alternative option to conventional sports, climbing allows students to form bonds with their peers and stay active, while working through problems and participating in healthy competition. Geared specifically toward high school students, the WHSC caters to climbers of all ability levels.



All students receive training in belaying and knot tying, technique and movement, and bouldering through their weekly two-hour practice. They are then presented with opportunities to compete, attend community building events, and further their climbing skills through clinics. While some students find their passion in training for competitions, others find joy in simply being a part of a climbing community at their team's weekly practice. This diversity, and the dedication of the coaches, is what makes the Wisconsin High School Climbing League so special.



HISTORY

- 1998** Adventure Rock Brookfield opens on February 16th.
- 2009** Wisconsin High School Climbing League starts, with about 30 students and three schools.
- 2016** Adventure Rock opens a second location in Milwaukee on June 18th, making climbing more accessible to Milwaukee-area schools.
- 2017** WHSCL holds its first ever State Finals competition on May 12th to finish the 2016-2017 season. 95 students from 13 teams compete.
- 2020** Adventure Rock Walker's Point opens on August 25th.
- 2023**
- Odyssey Climbing + Fitness Green Bay opens on February 6th, expanding the league to a facility outside of Adventure Rock for the first time and adding North East Wisconsin as a WHSCL region.
 - An official Handbook and Rulebook are introduced in the Fall of 2023, providing more structure to the league.
 - Community Building Committee forms, and High School Hangouts begin as alternative league-wide events to competitions.
- 2024**
- Odyssey Green Bay hosts their first WHSCL competition on March 16th.
 - Web-based Scoring App is created and implemented for the 2024-2025 season, making competitions more efficient.
 - Climb @ the Loop in Burlington joins the league in the fall.
 - Greater Heights opens on December 2nd, expanding the league to Madison.
- 2025**
- Odyssey Climbing + Fitness opens a second location in Appleton on September 13th.
 - Code of Conduct is introduced.
- 2026**
- Odyssey Appleton hosts their first WHSCL Competition on January 10th.
 - League splits into two Conferences due to its tremendous growth, to allow more students to compete.
- 2027** Greater Heights hosts their first WHSCL competition on February 6th.



WHSC OVERVIEW

WHAT TO EXPECT

- Weekly two-hour team practice
- Instruction in knot tying, belaying, & basic climbing technique
- Top Rope and Bouldering Competitions, including State Finals
- High School Hangouts
- Unlimited access to the gym with a Membership
- Clinics offered at an additional cost to students interested in learning more advanced climbing techniques

COMPETITIONS

Competitions are offered on a monthly basis, culminating with a State Finals competition in the spring. Are competitions required? Nope. But are competitions super fun? Absolutely. What's unique about WHSCL competitions is that there's room for all ability levels, even beginners. Check out our competition Divisions below.

DIVISIONS

Top Rope

Division 1 | 5.9

Division 2 | 5.10

Division 3 | 5.11

Division 4 | 5.12 & Up

Bouldering

Division 1 | V1

Division 2 | V2

Division 3 | V4

Division 4 | V4 & Up

HIGH SCHOOL HANGOUTS

High School Hangouts happen each month of the year, even during the summer. The best part of the Hangouts — they're FREE for ALL high schoolers, regardless of if you're officially part of the WHSCL or not. Most Hangouts include themes and activities. All Hangouts include snacks, climbing, and fun. Come Hang Out!

COST

League Fee—\$25/year

Competition Fee—\$20/comp

Practice Fee—Contact your team's coach or home facility for more information on Membership or Day Pass fees to attend practices.

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